experience are, in the opinion of the Administration, clearly equivalent to the requirements for the post to be filled, provided that, if such a person holds no appropriate certificate, the person shall be required to pass a test accepted by th e Administration as demonstrating that such a dispensation may safely be issued. In addition, the Administration shall ensure that the post in
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SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
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dispensation may safely be issued. In addition, the Administration shall ensure that the post in question is filled by the holder of an appropriate certificate as soon as possible.
3 Each Party shall, as soon as possible after 1 January each year, send a report to the Secretary-General giving information of the total number of dispensations in respect of each capacity for which a certificate is required, including nil returns.
Regulation I/10
Equivalents
1 The Convention shall not prevent a Party from retaining or adopting other educational and training arrangements, including those involving seagoing service and shipboard organization especially adapted to technical developments and to special types of vessels, provided that the level of seagoing service, knowledge and efficiency as regards navigational and technical handling of vessels ensures a degree of safety at sea and has a preventive effect
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SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
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and technical handling of vessels ensures a degree of safety at sea and has a preventive effect as regards pollution at least equivalent to the requirements of the Convention.
2 Details of such arrangements shall be included in the report under article 4.
RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024)
AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND
WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention)
- 9 -
Regulation I/11
Use of simulators
1 The performance standards and other provisions set forth in section A-I/11 and such other requirements as are prescribed in part A of the STCW -F Code for any certificate concerned shall be complied with in respect of:
.1 all simulator-based training;
.2 any assessment of competency required by part A of the STCW -F Code which is carried out by means of a simulator; and
.3 any demonstration, by means of a simulator, of continued proficiency
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SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
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which is carried out by means of a simulator; and
.3 any demonstration, by means of a simulator, of continued proficiency required by part A of the STCW-F Code.
Regulation I/12
Medical standards
1 Each Party shall establish standards of medical fitness for fishing vessel personnel

and procedures for the issue of a medical certificate in accordance with the provisions of this regulation and of section A-I/12 of the STCW-F Code.
2 Each Party shall ensure that those responsible for assessing the medical fitness of fishing vessel personnel are medical practitioners recognized by the Party for the purpose of fishing vessel personnel medical examinations, in accordance with the provis ions of section A-I/12 of the STCW-F Code.
3 Every crew member holding a certificate issued under the provisions of the Convention who is serving at sea shall also hold a valid medical certificate issued in
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Convention who is serving at sea shall also hold a valid medical certificate issued in accordance with the provisions of this regulation and of section A-I/12 of the STCW-F Code.
4 Every candidate for certification shall:
.1 be not less than 16 years of age; or
.2 be not less than 15 years of age provided that the candidate is authorized by the competent authority in accordance with national laws and practice;
.3 provide satisfactory proof of his or her identity; and
.4 meet the applicable medical fitness standards established by the Party.
5 Medical certificates shall remain valid for a maximum period of two years unless the crew member is under the age of 18, in which case the maximum period of validity shall be one year.
6 If the period of validity of a medical certificate expires in the course of a voyage, then the medical certificate shall continue in force until the next port of call where a medical
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the medical certificate shall continue in force until the next port of call where a medical practitioner recognized by the Party is available, provided that the period shall not exceed three months.

7 In urgent cases the Administration may permit a crew member to work without a valid medical certificate until the next port of call where a medical practitioner recognized by the Party is available, provided that:
.1 the period of permission does not exceed three months; and
.2 the crew member concerned is in possession of an expired medical certificate of recent date.
CHAPTER II
Certification of skippers, officers in charge of a navigational watch, engineer officers and radio operators
Regulation II/1

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CHAPTER II
Certification of skippers, officers in charge of a navigational watch,
engineer officers and radio operators
Regulation II/1
Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of skippers on fishing vessels of 24 metres
in length and over operating in unlimited waters
1 Every skipper on a fishing vessel of 24 metres in length and over operating in unlimited
waters shall hold a certificate of competency.
2 Every candidate for certification shall:
.1 meet the requirements for certification as an officer in charge of a navigational
watch on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length and over operating in unlimited
waters, and have approved seagoing service of not less than 12 months as an
officer in charge of a navigational watch or skipper on fishing vessels of not less
than 12 metres in length. However, the Party may allow the substitution of a period
not exceeding six months of approved seagoing service as an officer in charge of
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not exceeding six months of approved seagoing service as an officer in charge of
a navigational watch on seagoing ships covered by the 1978 STCW Convention;
and
.2 meet the standard of competence specified in section A-II/1 of the STCW-F Code.
3 A candidate who holds a valid certificate of competency issued in accordance with
the provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention need not be reassessed in those standards of
competence listed in section A -II/1 of the STCW -F Code that were required at a highe r or
equivalent level for the issuance of the corresponding 1978 STCW Convention certificate.
Regulation II/2
Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of officers in charge of a navigational watch
on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length and over operating in unlimited waters
1 Every officer in charge of a navigational watch on a fishing vessel of 24 metres in
length and over operating in unlimited waters shall hold a certificate of competency.

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length and over operating in unlimited waters shall hold a certificate of competency.
2 Every candidate for certification shall:
.1 be not less than 18 years of age;
.2 have approved seagoing service of not less than:
.1 12 months on fishing vessels or fishing training vessels of not less
than 12 metres in length as part of an approved training programme
which includes onboard training that meets the requirements of
section A -II/2 of the STCW -F Code and is documented in an
approved training record book; or

.2 two years in the deck department on fishing vessels of not less
than 12 metres in length. However, the Administration may allow the

substitution of the seagoing service by a period of special training
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than 12 metres in length. However, the Administration may allow the
substitution of the seagoing service by a period of special training
not exceeding one year, provided that the period of the special
training programme shall be at least equivalent in value to the period
of the required seagoing service it substitutes or by a period of
approved seagoing service evidenced by an approved record book
covered by the 1978 STCW Convention;
.3 meet the standard of competence specified in section A-II/2 of the STCW-F
Code; and
.4 meet the applicable requirements of regulation II/6, as appropriate for
performing designated radio duties in accordance with the Radio
Regulations.
3 A candidate who holds a valid certificate of competency issued in accordance with
the provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention need not be reassessed in those standards of
competence listed in section A -II/2 of the STCW -F Code that were required at a highe r or
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competence listed in section A -II/2 of the STCW -F Code that were required at a highe r or
equivalent level for the issuance of the corresponding 1978 STCW Convention certificate.
Regulation II/3
Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of skippers on fishing vessels of 24 metres
in length and over operating in limited waters
1 Every skipper on a fishing vessel of 24 metres in length and over operating in limited
waters shall, unless they hold certificates issued in compliance with regulation II/1, hold a
certificate of competency issued in compliance with at least the provisions of this regulation.
2 Every candidate for certification shall:
.1 meet the requirements for certification as an officer in charge of a
navigational watch on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length and over
operating in limited or unlimited waters, and have approved seagoing service
of not less than 12 months as an officer in charge of a navigational watch or
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SOURCE: MSC.561(108).pdf
URL:
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of not less than 12 months as an officer in charge of a navigational watch or
skipper on fishing vessels of not less than 12 metres in length. However, a
Party may allow the substitution of a period not exceeding six months o f
approved seagoing service as an officer in charge of a navigational watch on